

enough to do almost anything, but not powerful enough to do everything by itself.

Emmott's China-India-Japan theme has seemingly been inspired by this reviewer's 2006 book, *Asian Juggernaut: The Rise of China, India and Japan*, the first study of that strategic triangle. But Emmott's book, contrary to its title, focuses not on the "power struggle" between these "rivals" and how that will "shape our next decade", but on their supposed strengths and their determination to regain their historical power. More journalistic than scholarly, the book makes desultory recommendations—half of them addressed to the US—that have little to do with its title.

Khanna's easy-to-read, insightful book offers a rich tour of the emerging geopolitical landscape stretching from Asia and the Middle East to Eastern Europe and South America. He sees the US, EU and China as the only great powers and clubs dozens of other countries, including India, Russia and Japan, as the new "Second World", comprising swing-states that will determine which superpower gains the upper hand. The geopolitics of the 21st century, he writes, will centre on the "new Big Three"—not Russia, a petrostate facing depopulation and run by the "Kremlin-Gazprom oligarchy"; not the Islamic world; and not India, which he sees as lacking both clear, long-term goals and strategic appetite. History testifies that without establishing primacy in its own neighbourhood, no country has sustained itself as a great power. But India continues to be tormented even by smaller neighbours. So Khanna's scepticism on India may be right.

Khanna's projected big picture appears less plausible: the Big Three will make the rules for all, and the other states will be left merely to "choose their suitors in this post-American world". He forgets that his Big Three have interests that won't be easy to reconcile, posing a hurdle to their rule-setting. While China wants a multipolar world and a unipolar Asia, the US wants a multipolar Asia but a unipolar world. Despite having travelled to some 40 "Second-World" countries to research the book, Khanna speciously concludes that these states are destined to play second fiddle to the "Big Three". He couldn't be more wrong. ■

TOP 10

BESTSELLERS

A monthly national list of bestselling books compiled for INDIA TODAY by ORG-MARG based on data from 15 retail outlets in six cities.

FICTION

NO.	TITLE	AUTHOR	PUBLISHER
1. (1)	A Prisoner of Birth	Jeffrey Archer	Macmillan
2. (7)	Unaccustomed Earth	Jhumpa Lahiri	Random House
3. (2)	The Appeal	John Grisham	Random House
4. (5)	The Kite Runner	Khaled Hosseini	Bloomsbury
5. (6)	Shantaram	Gregory David Roberts	Penguin

NON-FICTION

NO.	TITLE	AUTHOR	PUBLISHER
1. (1)	The Secret	Rhonda Byrne	Atria
2. (2)	My Country, My Life	L.K. Advani	Rupa
3. (3)	We Are Like That Only: Understanding the Logic of Consumer India	Rama Bijapurkar	Penguin
4. (4)	The Monk Who Sold His Ferrari	Robin S. Sharma	Jaico
5. (7)	The Elephant, the Tiger and the Cellphone: Reflections on India in the 21st Century	Shashi Tharoor	Penguin

OTHER INDIAN BOOKS IN THE TOP 20

FICTION

NO.	TITLE	AUTHOR	PUBLISHER
7. (4)	The Japanese Wife	Kunal Basu	HarperCollins
10. (-)	The 3 Mistakes of My Life	Chetan Bhagat	Rupa
13. (-)	The Age of Shiva	Manil Suri	Bloomsbury
14. (19)	The Enchantress of Florence	Salman Rushdie	Jonathan Cape

NON-FICTION

NO.	TITLE	AUTHOR	PUBLISHER
6. (12)	Maximum City: Bombay Lost and Found	Suketu Mehta	Penguin
7. (-)	The Case of The Bonsai Manager	R. Gopalakrishnan	Penguin
9. (-)	Superstar India: From Incredible to Unstoppable	Shobhaa De	Penguin

Last month's rating in brackets

Participating bookshops: Delhi: Om Book Shop, Faqir Chand, Teksons, Full Circle; Mumbai: Crossword, Shah Book Stall, Danai Book Shop; Bangalore: Fountainhead, Gangarams; Hyderabad: Walden Book Link, The Book Point; Kolkata: Oxford Books, Modern Book Depot, Family Book Shop; Chennai: Fountainhead